

NATURE

SOLO

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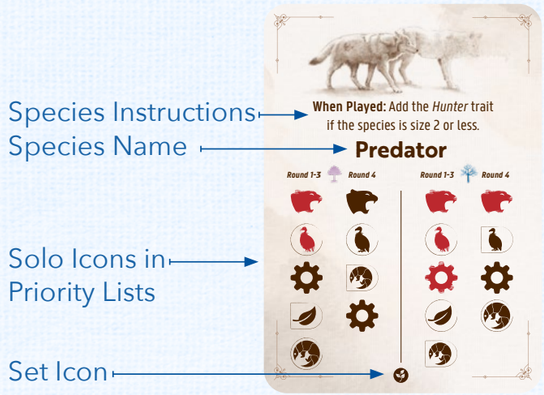
NATURE SOLO

INTRODUCTION

In *Nature Solo,* you play against an automated opponent named Rani (“rah-nee”) who uses a deck of solo cards to make decisions. *Nature Solo* can be played at five different difficulty levels.

A game of *Nature Solo* is played using the standard *Nature* rules. Additionally, Rani has special rules that will take precedence if there is a conflict. Can you adapt better than Rani?

COMPONENTS





SETUP

Nature Solo is set up like a 2-player game of *Nature*. Follow the steps on page 4 of the *Nature* rulebook then do the following:

- Choose a difficulty: Mouse (easiest), Rabbit, Fox (medium), Tiger, or Snow Leopard (most challenging). If it is your first game, we recommend playing at the Mouse difficulty.
- Set up a player screen for Rani.
- Shuffle and place the six solo cards face-down to create Rani’s deck.
- Choose who will play first between you and Rani. There will be four rounds.

PREPARATION

New Species

When getting a new species for Rani use the standard rules (*Nature*, page 7) with the following changes:

- When Rani gets a new species, it is always placed to the right of any existing species in her player area.
- Each of Rani’s species will have a solo card. Draw the top card of Rani’s deck and play it face-up with the new species. This is not a trait card, so it does not count toward the limit of 3 traits.
- Whenever drawing a new solo card, cover the icons below the blue tree (the right-hand side) using the size dial, or any component you prefer. Pay attention to any species instructions, if applicable.

First Round Only

Rani starts the game with an additional species. After creating Rani’s first species, immediately make a second species for Rani. Draw a solo card for each species.

The second species starts with population equal to the number in your selected difficulty:

Difficulty:	Mouse	Rabbit	Fox	Tiger	Snow Leopard
Starting Population of 2nd Species:	1	2	3	4	5

Draw Cards

Rani draws cards equal to the number in your selected difficulty:

Difficulty:	Mouse	Rabbit	Fox	Tiger	Snow Leopard
Number of Cards Drawn:	5	6	7	8	9

Do not look at Rani’s cards. Place them face-down in a stack, hereafter called her “hand.” If Rani has any cards set aside from a previous round, shuffle those into her hand after drawing new cards.

ADAPTING PHASE

You always go first during the Adapting Phase.

The Adapting Phase uses the standard rules (*Nature*, page 8) with the following changes for Rani:

Fourth Round Only
Set aside one card from Rani's hand for each of Rani's species that can **forage** from the watering hole. Keep these cards face-down and set aside until step 3, when they are considered back in her hand.



Play Rani's Hand

Draw a card from the top of Rani's hand one at a time. Follow these steps for each card drawn:

1. **Check the solo icon** in the bottom left corner of the drawn card to determine species priority.

   Each solo card has four columns of solo icons organized into four priority lists. These lists are read from top to bottom when determining species priority. The priority list is divided into sides: "purple tree"(left) and "blue tree"(right).

   Each side has two columns divided by the round; "round 1-3" and "round 4". To determine which species has priority, use the visible priority list corresponding to the correct round. Note: Rani can switch sides during the game.

2. **Assign this card** to Rani's species with the solo icon highest on its priority list. Whenever two or more species have the solo icon at the same priority, assign it to the leftmost (oldest) species first.



It is Rani's turn to adapt. The first card you draw for Rani is Plated. *The solo icon is a gear. The two species Rani has on the table are the* Evader *and the* Glutton. *Only the purple tree side is showing for both. Look at the Round 1-3 column on both the* Evader *and the* Glutton. *The* Evader *has the gear higher up on the priority list so this card will be played on the* Evader.

Each solo icon on the priority list has three unique presentations that will determine the action taken: no border, a circle border, or a D-shaped border. Perform the action corresponding to the solo icon's presentation:

No border: The card is added to the species as a **trait**.

If you cannot play this trait to this species for any reason *(for example, the species already has 3 traits or the card itself prevents you from doing so),* skip this species and assign the drawn card to the species with this solo icon in the next highest priority.

In a circle: Discard the card and increase **population** .

In a D-shaped border: Discard the card and increase **size**.

If the species is already at maximum size, skip this species and assign the drawn card to the species with this solo icon in the next highest priority.

The solo icon may also be red, which requires an additional step that is taken after.

Red Icon: Give this species the *Hunter* trait if it is not a hunter. If this species already has three traits, shuffle its existing trait cards and randomly discard one before adding the *Hunter* trait.

If no species can be assigned the card, Rani will keep the card face-down in her hand.

The gear icon on the Evader *solo card has no border, so* Plated *is played as a trait. If the* Evader *already had 3 traits then this card would be assigned to the next species with the gear at the next highest priority. The border of the gear solo icon on* Glutton *is D-shaped, so the card would be discarded to increase size for the* Glutton.



3. **If Rani has no species that can forage from the watering hole in the next phase (Feeding Phase),** then follow the additional Adapting Phase rules below:
   - Rani will use all cards in her face-down hand from step 2 to increase size for her species. For each card, Rani will increase the size of the species that has the card's solo icon at the highest priority. If that species is at maximum size, move on to the next species with the card's solo icon at the highest priority. If priority is tied, the card goes to the leftmost (oldest) species first.
   - Once all of Rani's species are at maximum size, she will use any remaining cards to increase population for the species with the card's solo icon at the highest priority. If priority is tied, the card goes to the leftmost (oldest) species first.

RANI'S FEEDING PHASE

The Feeding Phase uses the standard rules (*Nature*, page 14) with the following changes for Rani:

1. Rani will always **forage** first if she can. Rani will first **eat** with the species that will provide her with the most food by **foraging**. If two or more are tied, she will **eat** with the leftmost (oldest) species.
2. If Rani cannot take the **forage** action, she will **hunt**, starting with the leftmost (oldest) species that can **hunt**.

Foraging Species

Rani will choose which forager to **eat** based on plant available in the watering hole.

When determining how much food can be **eaten**, Rani will consider there to be three additional plants in the watering hole for each card left in her hand. For example, if Rani has two cards in her hand, with one plant remaining in the watering hole, she will consider there to be seven plants in the watering hole, six from the two cards she has in her hand plus one visible in the watering hole.

Before the forager **eats**, if there is less food in the watering hole than the forager can **eat**, Rani will discard a random card from her hand and add plants to the watering hole equal to the food value printed on the discarded card. She will do this multiple times if she is able until there is as much plants as the forager can **eat**.



Rani's Species

*There are 5 plant in the watering hole. Both of Rani's species would **forage** for 4 plant. Rani will feed the* Evader *as it is the leftmost species and will provide the* Scavenger *with 2 meat due to* Opportunistic*, for a total of 6 **eaten** food. If there was only 3 plant in the watering hole, Rani would discard a card to add more plant so she can take the maximum 4 that her* Evader *could **eat**.*

Hunting Species

Rani will choose which species to feed when **hunting**, in this order:

1. She will **eat** the species that loses her the least population across all her species.
   *(For example: Rani can **eat** 2 species. One is your size 4 species with Horned which will **kill** 4 of Rani's species population. The other is her own which will only **kill** 1 population on her hunted species. She chooses to **eat** her own species and lose 1 population instead of 4.)*
2. She will prefer to **eat** one of your species, before her own.
3. If there are ties, she will try to **eat** the smallest (size dial only) of those species first.
4. If still tied, she will try to **eat** the leftmost (oldest) of those species first.



Rani's Species



Your Species

Rani's leftmost hunter species, the Evader, ***hunts** your size 2 species. None of Rani's population will be **killed**. The* Evader *eats 2 meat. The* Evader *would not **hunt** your size 1 species, since* Horned *would **kill** one population. If your size 1 species did not have* Horned*, she would **eat** the size 1 species first.*

Starving

If Rani has hungry population but cannot **eat**, Rani will **starve** population in this order:

1. The leftmost (oldest) hunter.
2. Any forager that has not yet **eaten**; if two or more have not yet **eaten**, **starve** the one with the lowest population first; if still tied, **starve** the leftmost (oldest) species.
3. Any remaining forager, starving leftmost (oldest) first, if more than one remains.

Losing Population

Rani will always choose a hungry population to be **killed**, in preference to a fed population. Keep any **killed** population next to the solo card to keep track during the round.

Extinction

When one of Rani's species goes extinct, place the solo card on the bottom of Rani's deck and follow extinction rules (*Nature*, page 17).

SCORING

Before scoring, place any of Rani's **killed** population next to her player screen. For each of Rani's species that had 1 or more population **killed** this round:

- Switch which priority lists that species uses in the next round. If the species used the priority lists below the blue tree in the last round, cover the priority lists below the blue tree and use the priority lists below the purple tree next round and vice versa.
- Shuffle that species' existing trait cards and discard one at random. If that species' *Hunter* trait is discarded, they will switch back to being a forager.

The game ends after four rounds. Score more points than Rani to win the game!

GAME DESIGN

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